

CHINESE AUSTRALIAN CHRISTIAN VILLAGE · WEEKLY BULLETIN

Admin Quick Start Guide

Everything you need to fill in the Google Sheet, generate the weekly bulletin, and understand what gets published — in one place.

For bulletin administrators & pastoral team · System: Automated Bulletin Pipeline v2 · Updated March 2026

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Quick reference: If you just need to do the routine weekly update, follow Steps 1–6 (sections 4–9) then jump to section 10 to generate. The whole process takes about 10–15 minutes once you're familiar with it.

1. Welcome

The CACV Bulletin Automation system produces the weekly Sunday bulletin automatically — translating Chinese content, generating QR codes for announcements, composing a polished web bulletin and a print-ready booklet PDF, then publishing it to the website and sending notification emails.

Your job as admin is simple: keep the Google Sheet up to date each week, then press a single button to trigger generation. Everything else — formatting, translation, PDF layout, website publishing — happens automatically.

What the system does for you

- Translates Chinese service details and announcements (via AI)
- Generates a styled web bulletin at phoaar.github.io/cacv-bulletin-automation
- Creates a print-ready A4 landscape booklet PDF (fold & staple)
- Attaches any extra PDF documents (e.g. Communion service insert) automatically
- Sends notification emails to configured recipients
- Optionally publishes to the church WordPress website

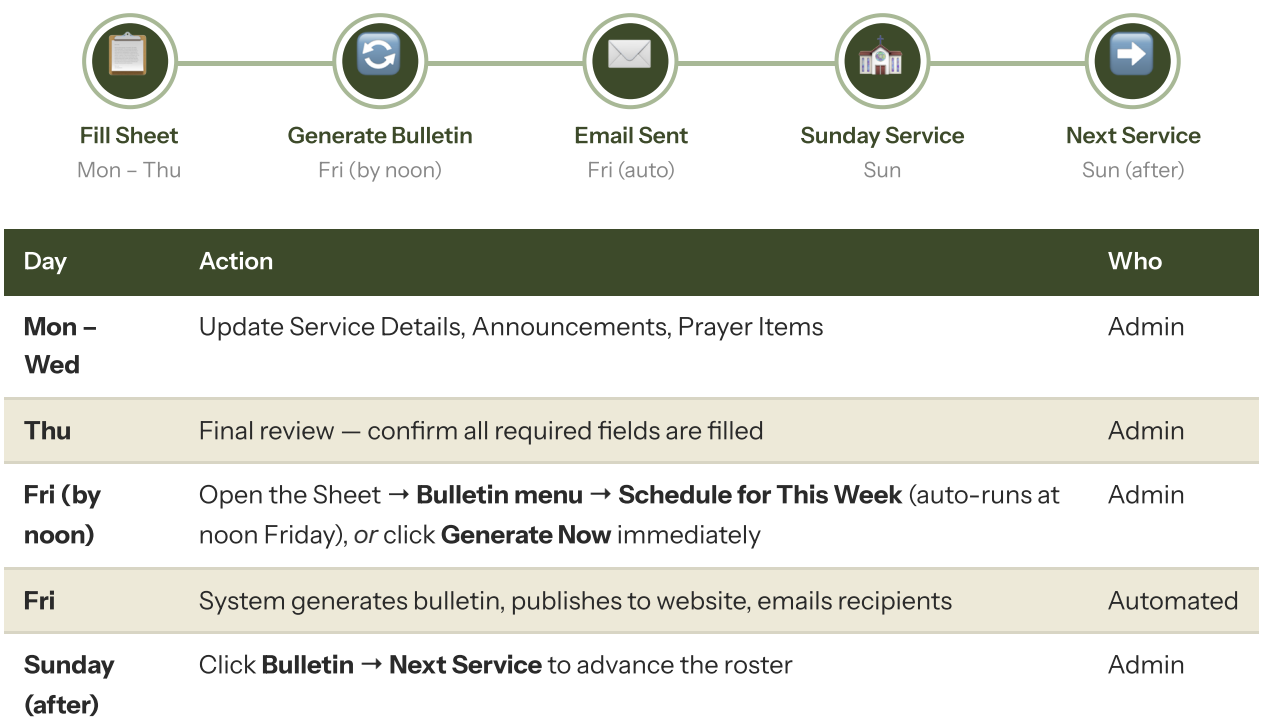
What you are responsible for

- Filling in the  **Service Details** tab each week
- Updating  **Order of Service**,  **Announcements**, and  **Prayer Items**
- Checking that  **Events** are current
- Triggering bulletin generation via the **Bulletin** menu (or scheduling it)
- Clicking **Next Service** after Sunday to advance the roster

Tip: You do not need to touch anything in  **Roster** — that is maintained by the church secretary. The system reads it automatically.

2. Weekly Workflow Overview

The typical weekly cycle runs from Monday to Sunday:



Important: If you use *Schedule for This Week*, the bulletin will generate automatically at Friday noon — you do not need to do anything else that day. However, make sure all content is entered *before* noon Friday.

3. The Google Sheet at a Glance

The Sheet has 7 tabs. The first 4 rows of each tab are header rows — data starts on row 5. Cells highlighted **yellow** are required; the rest are optional or auto-filled.

Tab	Purpose	Who edits?
 Service Details	Date, sermon, preacher, language, special notes. Main data entry tab.	Admin
 Order of Service	Each row = one item in the service (song, prayer, sermon, etc.).	Admin
 Announcements	Title + body text for each announcement. URLs become QR codes.	Admin
 Prayer Items	Prayer requests grouped by category (Praise, Church, Community, etc.).	Admin
 Roster	Weekly duty roster (Preacher, Chair, Worship, Ushers, etc.). Read-only for admins.	Church Secretary
 Events	Upcoming events. Past events are hidden automatically.	Admin
 Settings	Email recipients, WordPress settings, PDF password, generation log.	Admin (occasionally)

 *Google Sheet — overview of all 7 tabs (requires Google login to screenshot)*

Sheet protections: The Roster tab and formula-driven cells are protected — you will see a padlock icon if you try to edit them. This is intentional; the system reads these values automatically. Never try to override a protected cell.

4. Step 1 – Service Details

1 Start here every week

The  **Service Details** tab is the main data entry tab. It uses key-value rows: column A is the field name, column B is your value.

Required fields must fill

Field (Column A)	What to enter	Example
Service Date	Date of the upcoming Sunday service	2 March 2026
Sermon Title	Full sermon title (English)	Walking in the Light
Sermon Title (Chinese)	Chinese sermon title (auto-translated if blank)	行在光中
Scripture	Bible passage reference	1 John 1:5–10
Preacher	Preacher name (auto-filled from Roster)	Rev. David Chan
Service Type	Regular / Communion / Special	Regular
Language	Primary language of the service	Cantonese

Auto-filled fields (do not type)

The following fields are pulled automatically from other tabs or the Roster — leave them as-is unless the auto-fill is wrong:

- Chair**, **Worship**, **Music**, **PA**, **Ushers** — from Roster tab
- Morning Tea** — from Roster tab

Optional fields

- Special Notes** — any one-off message shown on the bulletin header
- PDF Attachment URL** — Google Drive URL of a PDF to append to the booklet (e.g. Communion service insert). Must be a shared Drive link.
- PDF Password** — set a password on the output PDF (overrides system default)

 *Service Details tab — filled example (requires Google login)*

Sermon / Scripture rows in Order of Service are formula-driven. Do *not* type directly into those cells — the values flow from Service Details automatically. If you need to change the sermon title, update it here in Service Details.

5. Step 2 – Order of Service

2 Define the service flow

Each row in this tab represents one item in the Sunday service programme. The bulletin lists items in the order they appear here.

Columns

Column	What to enter
Item	Short name of the item (e.g. <code>Opening Prayer</code> , <code>Praise & Worship</code>)
Item (Chinese)	Chinese name — auto-translated if blank
Detail	Optional extra info (e.g. song title, Scripture reference)
Detail (Chinese)	Chinese detail — auto-translated if blank
Leader	Person leading this item (if applicable)

Adding / reordering items

- To **add** a new item: type in the next empty row.
- To **reorder**: cut the row (right-click → Cut) and paste it where you need it.
- To **remove** an item: delete the row contents (or right-click → Delete row).

Do not edit the Sermon or Scripture rows directly. These rows contain formulas that pull values from the Service Details tab. Typing over them will break the link. If you accidentally overwrite one, press **Ctrl+Z / Cmd+Z** to undo.

Typical order of service

1. Welcome & Announcements
2. Opening Prayer
3. Praise & Worship (3–4 songs)
4. Scripture Reading
5. Sermon
6. Response / Altar Call
7. Offering
8. Communion (if applicable)
9. Benediction

  *Order of Service tab — example rows (requires Google login)*

6. Step 3 – Announcements

3 What's happening in the church

Each row in this tab is one announcement that appears on the bulletin. Announcements are shown in the web bulletin and in the print PDF.

Columns

Column	What to enter
Title required	Short heading for the announcement
Title (Chinese)	Chinese heading — auto-translated if blank
Body	Full announcement text. Can include dates, details, contacts.
Body (Chinese)	Chinese body — auto-translated if blank
URL	Optional link (registration, form, etc.). If provided, a QR code is generated automatically.
Keep next week?	Type Yes to carry this announcement forward when you click <i>Next Service</i> .

QR codes

If you enter a URL in the URL column, the system automatically generates a QR code that appears alongside the announcement in the print bulletin. This lets church members scan to register for events or access resources.

Tip: Use URL shorteners (e.g. bit.ly) for long links — shorter URLs produce cleaner QR codes that are easier to scan in print.

Keep next week?

When you click **Bulletin → Next Service** after Sunday, announcements with **Yes** in the *Keep next week?* column are preserved. All others are cleared. Use this for multi-week announcements.

  *Announcements tab — example with URL and Keep columns (requires Google login)*

7. Step 4 – Prayer Items 🙏

4 Weekly prayer needs

Each row is one prayer request shown on the bulletin. Items are grouped by **Category** on the bulletin.

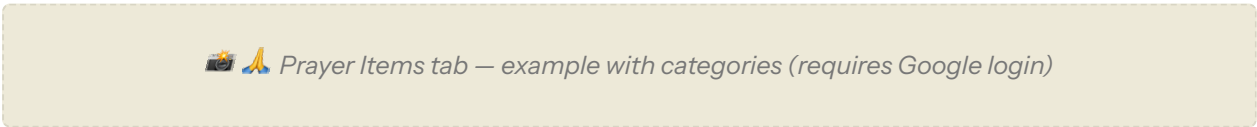
Columns

Column	What to enter
Category	Group name: Praise , Church , Community , World , etc.
Item required	The prayer request text (English)
Item (Chinese)	Chinese text — auto-translated if blank
Keep next week?	Type Yes to carry forward when Next Service is clicked

Typical categories

- **Praise** — thanksgiving and answered prayers
- **Church** — congregation-specific needs (sick members, ministry needs)
- **Community** — local community concerns
- **World** — broader global prayer points

Tip: Keep individual items concise (1-2 sentences). Long items may be truncated in the print bulletin layout.



  Prayer Items tab — example with categories (requires Google login)

8. Step 5 – Roster

5 Read-only — maintained by secretary

The  **Roster** tab lists who is on duty for each Sunday. It is **read-only for bulletin admins** — do not edit it.

Roster columns

Column	Duty
A	Date text (e.g. <i>1st Sunday of March</i>)
B	Year
C	Preacher
D	Chair
E	Worship leader
F	Music (band/organist)
G	PowerPoint operator
H	PA / sound
I	Chief Usher
J	Ushers
K	Morning Tea

How it works

- When you click **Bulletin → Next Service**, the system reads the *next* row in the Roster (by date) and auto-fills the Service Details tab.
- If a name is wrong on the bulletin, contact the church secretary to update the Roster. Do not type over the auto-filled cells in Service Details — they will be overwritten next time.

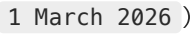
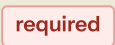
Protected tab: The Roster tab is sheet-protected. Attempting to edit it will show an error. If the duty assignments for a particular Sunday need to change, ask the church secretary.

9. Step 6 – Events

6 Upcoming church events

The  **Events** tab lists upcoming events shown in the *Events* section of the bulletin. Past events are hidden from the bulletin automatically — you don't need to delete old rows.

Columns

Column	What to enter
Date 	Event date (format:  or )
Title 	Event name
Title (Chinese)	Chinese name — auto-translated if blank
Description	Brief event details
Description (Chinese)	Auto-translated if blank
Show on bulletin?	 = include on bulletin;  = internal record only. Defaults to  if blank.

Auto-filtering: Only events with a date on or after the service date appear on the bulletin. You can safely add future events weeks in advance.

  *Events tab — example events (requires Google login)*

10. Generating the Bulletin

Once the Sheet is filled in, generating the bulletin takes a single click. The menu is in the Google Sheet menu bar under **Bulletin**.

 *Bulletin menu in Google Sheet — showing all menu options (requires Google login)*

Menu options explained

Menu Item	What it does	When to use
Generate Now	Runs the pipeline immediately — translates, generates, publishes, emails.	When you're ready to publish straight away
Schedule for This Week	Sets the system to auto-generate at Friday noon this week.	Normal weekly workflow — set and forget
Next Service	Advances the roster to the next Sunday, clears non-kept content.	After Sunday service, to prepare for next week
View PDF	Opens the published booklet PDF in a new tab.	To review the latest published bulletin
Custom Date...	Generate for a specific date (e.g. a special service).	Public holidays, Christmas, Easter, etc.

What happens when you click Generate Now

1. A confirmation dialog appears — click **OK** to proceed.
2. The script runs (takes 1–3 minutes). You'll see a progress bar.
3. On success, a green confirmation appears with a link to the live bulletin.
4. Email notifications are sent to all configured recipients.
5. The website is updated with the new bulletin and PDF.

Do not close the Sheet while generation is running — this can interrupt the Apps Script. Wait for the confirmation message before navigating away.

Validation check: If any required fields are missing, generation will stop and show a list of what needs to be filled in. Fix the missing fields and run again.

11. What Gets Published

Each generation run produces and publishes three things: a live web bulletin, a print booklet PDF, and email notifications.

Live web bulletin

A responsive web page at phoaar.github.io/cacv-bulletin-automation — designed for phone and desktop viewing. Church members can access it via the QR code on the print bulletin cover.



Booklet PDF (bulletin.pdf)

An A4 landscape PDF designed for folding in half to produce an A5 booklet. Print double-sided, fold in half, staple on the spine. 4 pages total:

Page	Content
Cover (front)	Church name, service date, sermon title, QR code to web bulletin
Back cover	Prayer items
Inside left	Order of service + duty roster
Inside right	Announcements & events



PDF attachment: If a Google Drive PDF URL is set in Service Details, that PDF is automatically appended to the booklet after the 4 main pages. Use this for Communion service inserts or devotional handouts.

Email notification

An email is sent to all recipients listed in the  **Settings** tab. It includes the bulletin PDF as an attachment and links to the live web bulletin.



12. After Service

After Sunday service, do two things to keep the system current for next week:

1. Click "Next Service"

In the Google Sheet, go to **Bulletin → Next Service**. This will:

- Advance the Roster pointer to the next Sunday
- Auto-fill preacher, chair, worship, and other roles from the Roster
- Clear announcements and prayer items *not* marked "Keep next week?"
- Update the service date in Service Details

Timing: Click Next Service on Sunday afternoon or Monday morning, before you begin entering content for the coming week.

2. Start next week's content

Once Next Service has run, the Sheet is ready for the coming week. Begin entering the new sermon details, announcements, and prayer items for next Sunday.

Don't click Next Service twice — it advances the Roster one row each time. If clicked accidentally, use **Ctrl+Z / Cmd+Z** to undo, or contact your system administrator to reset the roster pointer.

13. Settings & Notifications

The  **Settings** tab controls system-wide options. You rarely need to change these, but here is what each setting does.

Key settings

Setting	What it controls
Email Recipients	Comma-separated email addresses that receive the bulletin each week. Add or remove addresses here as team members change.
PDF Password	Password to protect the published PDF (recommended for privacy). If blank, falls back to the system default password.
WordPress Publish	Yes / No — whether to publish to the church WordPress site.
Generation Log	Read-only log of the last 10 generation runs — timestamp, status, and any errors. Check here if something seems wrong.

Adding email recipients

1. Open the  **Settings** tab
2. Find the **Email Recipients** row
3. In column B, add the new email address separated by a comma
4. Example: pastor@cacv.org.au, secretary@cacv.org.au, admin@cacv.org.au

Generation Log: After clicking Generate Now, check the Settings tab Generation Log section to confirm the run completed successfully. Each entry shows the timestamp, outcome (Success / Failed), and any error message.

  *Settings tab — Email Recipients and Generation Log (requires Google login)*

14. Troubleshooting

Most issues are caused by missing required fields or temporary network problems. Check the Generation Log in the  **Settings** tab for the error message, then use the table below.

Problem	Likely cause & fix
"Validation failed" error when generating	One or more required fields are empty. The error message lists exactly which fields need to be filled. Fix them and click Generate Now again.
Bulletin shows wrong preacher / roster names	The Roster tab may not be up to date. Ask the church secretary to correct it, then re-generate.
Translation didn't run — Chinese text missing	The AI translation service may have timed out. Re-run Generate Now. If persistent, check the Generation Log for an API error.
PDF not updated on website after generating	GitHub Pages can take 1–3 minutes to deploy. Wait a few minutes and refresh. Check the Generation Log confirms success.
Email not received after generation	Check Spam folder. Verify email addresses in  Settings → Email Recipients . Check the Generation Log for an email error.
QR code not appearing on an announcement	Make sure the URL column is a valid URL starting with <code>http://</code> or <code>https://</code> .
"Next Service" didn't advance the roster	The system could not find a future row in the Roster tab. Ask the church secretary to add more dates to the Roster.
PDF attachment not appearing in booklet	The Google Drive link in <i>Service Details</i> → <i>PDF Attachment URL</i> may not be publicly shared. Ensure the Drive file is set to "Anyone with the link can view".
Generation takes more than 5 minutes	The script may have hung. Close the confirmation dialog, wait 2 minutes, then try Generate Now again.
Apps Script "Authorization required" popup	Click Review Permissions and grant the requested permissions (this only happens once, or after a permission scope change).
Anything else	Note the exact error from the Generation Log and contact your system administrator with the error text and the date/time it occurred.

Best practice: Generate the bulletin on Thursday afternoon for a final check before scheduling Friday delivery. This gives time to fix any issues.

